About the Author

William Wordsworth (1770 – 1850) was a major English poet who, with Samuel Taylor Coleridge, helped to launch the Romantic Age in English Literature with their joint publication- Lyrical Ballads.



Wordsworth was Britain's Poet Laureate from 1843 until his death. He was popularly known as a Nature Poet. Some of his famous poems are *Daffodils, The Solitary Reaper, To the Cuckoo, The Tables Turned and Lines Composed a Few Miles above Tintern Abbey.*

Glossary:

grove – a small area of land with a group of trees

sate – old-fashioned spelling for sat

recline – lean back in a position of rest

grieve – mourn or to feel intense sorrow

primrose – a wild plant with yellow flowers

tufts – bunches

bower – a pleasant shady place under trees

periwinkle – a trailing plant with large blue flowers

wreaths – an arrangement of flowers in the shape of a circle

lament – to express sorrow or unhappiness about something

1. Find words from the poem that convey the following ideas:

a. connected together
b. spread over the surface of the ground in a straggling manner
c. make out or understand
d. slender woody shoots growing from branches or stems of trees

2. Complete the summary of the poem by filling in the blanks with the words given below.

The poet, in a relaxed state of mind, is sitting in a (1) _____. He reflects on how his mood brings (2) _____ thoughts, which are inevitably followed by (3)_____ones. He feels connected to all of nature, and senses an inherent joy in all (4)_____. He has faith in the fact that all the primroses and periwinkles around him (5)_____ the air they breathe. He feels that every bird in the grove moves with (6)_____. As the twigs catch the breezy air, they do so with the same pleasure (7)_____ all life on earth. This joy of nature seems to be heaven-sent. Nature's holy plan is to offer joy and peace to all forms of life on earth. The poet's pleasant train of thought slowly leads to the sad reflection of how mankind alone has wrought sorrow and (8)_____ upon itself. He firmly believes that man is meant to spend his days blissfully taking part in the vitality and joy surrounding him in (9)_____. He therefore concludes rhetorically, emphasizing that he has good reason to (10)_____ the distress, man unnecessarily brings upon himself.

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